PROJECT TITLE

# MINI PROJECT SYNOPSIS

*Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the award of the degree of*

**Bachelor of Technology**

*in*

**Computer Science & Engineering – AIML**

*Submitted to*

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**Session: 2026–27**

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# 1. INTRODUCTION

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is a branch of computer science that enables machines to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence, such as understanding language, recognising patterns and making decisions. One simple and useful application of AI is a chatbot, which can communicate with users through natural language and provide relevant information.

The proposed project, **AI-Based Chatbot for Student Assistance**, aims to develop a simple chatbot that can answer common student queries related to academic information, college activities, basic schedules, facilities and frequently asked questions. The project is designed to be easy to understand and demonstrate while introducing important AI concepts.

The chatbot can use Natural Language Processing (NLP) to analyse a user's question and identify the intended query. For a mini-project, the system can use a predefined set of questions and answers, along with simple text-processing techniques. This makes the project practical without requiring a very large dataset or complex deep-learning model.

## Technology and Important Terms

**Artificial Intelligence:** Technology that enables computers to perform tasks associated with human intelligence.
**Natural Language Processing:** An AI area concerned with processing and understanding human language.
**Chatbot:** A software application that interacts with users through text or conversation.
**Machine Learning:** A technique in which systems learn patterns from data to make predictions or decisions.
**Intent:** The purpose or meaning behind a user's query.

The proposed chatbot will provide a simple interface where a student enters a question and receives an appropriate response. The system may be implemented using Python with basic NLP libraries and a lightweight web interface. The project can later be extended with voice interaction, a larger knowledge base and machine-learning-based intent classification.

# 2. STATEMENT OF PROBLEM AND OBJECTIVES

Students often need quick answers to repetitive questions, but information may be spread across notices, websites, departments or other sources. Manually finding such information can take time. A chatbot can provide a single, simple interface for handling frequently asked questions.

## Problem Statement

To design and develop a simple AI-based chatbot that can understand common student queries and provide relevant responses in a user-friendly manner.

## Objectives

1. To develop a chatbot for answering common student-related queries.
2. To apply basic Natural Language Processing techniques to user input.
3. To identify common user intents and return suitable responses.
4. To provide a simple and easy-to-use interface for students.
5. To reduce the time required to obtain frequently requested information.
6. To create a project that can be extended with more advanced AI features.

# 3. LITERATURE SURVEY

Chatbots have been widely studied and developed for customer support, education, information retrieval and personal assistance. Earlier rule-based chatbots relied mainly on predefined patterns and responses. Modern systems increasingly use NLP and machine learning to improve their ability to interpret user input.

In educational environments, conversational systems can be used to answer frequently asked questions, guide students towards resources and provide basic academic assistance. Research in NLP has also introduced techniques for text classification, intent recognition and dialogue management, which are useful components of chatbot systems.

For the proposed mini project, a lightweight approach is preferred. A limited set of student-related intents can be created, such as timetable, attendance, examination information, department information and general college queries. The system can then match the user's input to an appropriate intent and generate a predefined response. This approach is suitable for a small academic project because it is easier to implement, test and explain.

The proposed work therefore combines the basic chatbot concept with introductory NLP techniques. It provides a foundation that can later be improved using machine-learning models, larger datasets and more advanced conversational AI.

# 4. EXPECTED OUTCOME / SCOPE OF THE PROJECT

## Expected Outcomes

The project is expected to produce a working chatbot prototype capable of accepting student questions and returning relevant answers. The system should demonstrate basic NLP-based processing and provide a simple conversational interface.

## Key Features

• Text-based interaction with the user.
• Recognition of common student queries.
• Predefined responses for frequently asked questions.
• Simple and user-friendly interface.
• Ability to add or update questions and responses.

## Intended Users

The primary users are students who need quick access to common academic or college-related information. The system may also be useful as a basic information-support tool for departments or institutions.

## Future Scope

Future versions can include voice-based interaction, multilingual support, machine-learning-based intent classification, database integration, personalised responses and connection with official college information systems.

# 5. TENTATIVE WORK PLAN

| Week | Major Activity |
|---|---|
| 1 | Requirement analysis and selection of chatbot features |
| 2 | Literature study and collection of relevant information |
| 3 | System design, conversation flow and dataset preparation |
| 4 | Basic NLP and intent-processing implementation |
| 5 | Chatbot response module development |
| 6 | User-interface development and integration |
| 7 | Testing, debugging and improvement |
| 8 | Performance checking and final refinements |
| 9 | Documentation and preparation of synopsis/report |
| 10 | Final demonstration and presentation |

The work plan follows the required 10-week project timeline and covers requirement analysis, literature study, design, development, testing, documentation and final presentation.

# 6. SOFTWARE / HARDWARE REQUIRED

| Category | Requirement |
|---|---|
| Operating System | Windows 10/11 or Linux |
| Programming Language | Python |
| IDE / Editor | Visual Studio Code / any Python-supported IDE |
| Libraries / Frameworks | Basic NLP libraries; Flask or Streamlit for interface (as required) |
| Database | Optional SQLite / simple file-based storage |
| Processor | Intel Core i3 or equivalent and above |
| RAM | Minimum 4 GB; 8 GB recommended |
| Storage | At least 5 GB free space |
| Internet | Required for downloading libraries and documentation |

The exact software stack may be adjusted during implementation depending on the selected chatbot approach and available resources.

# 7. REFERENCES

1. Russell, S. and Norvig, P., *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, Pearson.

2. Jurafsky, D. and Martin, J. H., *Speech and Language Processing*.

3. Python Software Foundation, *Python Documentation*.

4. Natural Language Toolkit (NLTK), *NLTK Documentation*.

5. Flask Documentation, *Flask Web Development Documentation*.

6. Streamlit Documentation, *Streamlit Documentation*.

Note: References should be updated with the exact books, research papers, documentation and websites actually used during the project development, following the format prescribed by the institute.